

RE: Takaichi UNGA debut: ICC support, enemy-state push, Trump bilateral · DPRK hypersonic test · Typhoon Dujuan 9 dead

NIKKEI 225

65,018.95

▲ +2.40%

USD/JPY

157.83

▲ +1.16%

BRENT

\$95.42

▼ -8.14%

BOJ RATE

1.25%

● TOP STORIES

POLITICS-DIET

Takaichi calls on UN to remove WWII 'enemy state' label in debut General Assembly address

Sanae Takaichi delivered Japan's first UN General Assembly speech of her term on September 22, demanding removal of WWII-era 'enemy state' clauses from the UN Charter that China and Russia have recently wielded against Japan; she also voiced Japan's 'consistent support' for the ICC without directly referencing US sanctions on the court. The NYT reports Beijing has latched onto the clause in its row with Tokyo, insisting it remains legally binding as a safeguard of the postwar order.

per NYT: "At the U.N., Japan's Leader Says It's Time to End 'Enemy State' Label"

NYT

ALLIANCE

Takaichi and Trump hold first formal summit since March, coordinate on China ahead of Xi's US visit

Takaichi met Trump on the UNGA sidelines on September 22 — their first formal summit since March — with the agenda focused on China's economic and security pressure, including economic security, and Japanese investment in the United States; Trump praised Takaichi for doing a 'tremendous job.' The talks took place *two days* before Trump's scheduled summit with Xi Jinping, with Tokyo watching for any US-China deal that could affect Japan's regional security equities.

per The Japan Times: "Takaichi and Trump discuss China ahead of Xi's visit to U.S."

THE JAPAN TIMES

INDO-PACIFIC

Typhoon Dujuan kills nine near Tokyo, four still missing as landslides and floods hit Chiba and Kanagawa

Typhoon Dujuan left nine dead — six in Chiba Prefecture and three in Kanagawa — with four people missing as of 8 a.m. Wednesday; more than 74,000 people had been under evacuation orders in the Tokyo region as authorities warned of landslides and floods. The Japan Times reported potentially record-breaking rainfall as the storm approached Tokyo.

per The Japan Times: "Typhoon Dujuan leaves at least nine dead and four missing near Tokyo"

ECONOMY-BOJ

BOJ's fastest rate-hike pace since 1990 raises questions about next move as yen weakens

Bloomberg hosted a live Q&A on the trajectory of BOJ policy after Japan raised rates to 1.25% — the highest in 31 years — at the fastest tightening pace since 1990, with the weaker yen and an AI-driven equity rally setting the stage for Japan's market return. Governor Ueda's guarded public stance highlights constraints on further near-term tightening.

BLOOMBERG JAPAN · SEP 23

DPRK

North Korea reports successful test of new weapon system described as hypersonic, Kim calls it 'incurable headache' for enemies

North Korea's state media reported a successful test of a 'new-type weapon' that outside experts assess as a hypersonic missile system; **Kim Jong Un** described the weapon as an 'incurable headache' for adversaries. The test follows two ballistic missile launches on September 20, the 14th missile provocation tracked in the trilateral US-Japan-ROK consultations.

REUTERS · SEP 23

POLITICS-DIET

Takaichi voices ICC support under domestic pressure, stops short of naming US sanctions on court

Takaichi had been under domestic pressure to publicly endorse the ICC after the US sanctioned the court and its Japanese president; in her UNGA speech she said postwar Japan had 'emphasised the rule of law in the resolution of all conflicts' and cited the ICC without naming Washington's actions. The Guardian notes she did not directly reference US sanctions on the court or its Japanese president.

per The Guardian: "Japan PM pledges support for international criminal court after Trump calls it 'out of control'"

THE GUARDIAN

• STAT OF THE DAY

9

Deaths from Typhoon Dujuan near Tokyo as of Sep 23 morning

Chiba Prefecture reported six deaths and Kanagawa three, with four people still missing across the two prefectures as of 8 a.m. Wednesday.

Typhoon Dujuan leaves at least nine dead and four missing near Tokyo — Japan Times

• JAPANESE GOVERNMENT

KANTEI/PM · CABINET · MOFA · MOD · METI · MOF · BOJ · DIET · WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 23, 2026

PM Watch: PM appeared today · 0 day(s) since last confirmed appearance — Prime Minister Takaichi delivered Japan's first UNGA address of her term on September 22, met President Trump bilaterally, and held her first meeting with Ukrainian President Zelenskyy on the UNGA sidelines in New York.

官邸 · PRIME MINISTER'S OFFICE (KANTEI) · *Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi*

Delivered inaugural UNGA address, calling for removal of UN Charter 'enemy state' clauses and supporting ICC

Prime Minister **Sanae Takaichi** delivered Japan's first address of her term at the 81st UN General Assembly on September 22, voicing Japan's 'consistent support' for the International Criminal Court despite US sanctions on the body, and calling on the UN to remove WWII-era 'enemy state' language from the Charter that China and Russia have recently invoked against Japan. She also urged UN Security Council reform.

→ Kantei ↗

外務省 · MINISTRY OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS (MOFA) · *Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi*

Japan-US Summit Meeting held on UNGA sidelines in New York

Takaichi met President Trump on September 22 — their first formal summit since March — with talks focused on China, including economic security, ahead of Trump's summit with Chinese leader Xi Jinping. Trump praised Takaichi for doing a 'tremendous job' and both sides reaffirmed the alliance.

→ MOFA ↗

官邸 · PRIME MINISTER'S OFFICE (KANTEI) · *Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi*

Takaichi holds first bilateral with Ukrainian President Zelenskyy, pledges continued pressure on Russia

In her first meeting with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, Takaichi vowed Japan would maintain pressure on Russia; the Ukrainian side did not publicly raise the possibility of defense cooperation such as drone development or air defense equipment tieups with Tokyo.

→ NHK ↗

• PUBLIC SENTIMENT & APPROVAL POLLING

POLLSTER	APPROVE	DISAPPROVE
ANN · Sep 23, 2026	58.3%	27.6%
Kyodo · Sep 23, 2026	53.4%	30.9%
Nikkei · Sep 5, 2026	62%	33%
Yomiuri · Sep 19, 2026	59%	30%

FNN · Sep 15, 2026	61.6%	32.2%
NHK · Sep 10, 2026	52.8%	30.8%
JNN · Sep 7, 2026	62.5%	34.9%
Asahi · Sep 5, 2026	53%	33%

Discourse: Takaichi's approval held at 53% (NHK/Kyodo) to 62% (Nikkei) after the September 17 cabinet reshuffle; her UNGA debut and ICC stance drew domestic attention amid US pressure on allies to distance themselves from the court.

Poll tracker: **Observing Japan approval-rating aggregator** →

• BUSINESS & ECONOMY

FINANCE · NIKKEI ASIA

Japan's major banks post first sustained post-bubble rise in domestic loan share

Japan's largest banks recorded the first sustained increase in their domestic loan market share since the asset-price bubble era, a structural shift with implications for monetary policy transmission as the BOJ raises rates.

TECH · NIKKEI ASIA · NEC, META

Japan's NEC joins Meta on ultrafast US-France undersea fiber-optic cable

NEC Corporation joined Meta's project to build an ultrafast undersea fiber-optic cable linking the United States and France, expanding Japan's footprint in global critical digital infrastructure.

REGIONAL PRESSURE WATCH WATCH

Heavy — 40 items (DPRK-heavy: 37 DPRK re Japan, 1 China MOFA, 1 BOJ, 1 Kantei)

CHINA

China's Foreign Ministry spokesperson, responding to Japan's UNGA speech and Typhon missile deployment, cited 'risks over Typhon in Japan' via ECNS, continuing Beijing's sustained framing of Japan's defense posture as escalatory remilitarization. China separately urged Japan to 'draw lessons from history' and 'win trust through concrete actions' in response to Takaichi's enemy-state UN remarks.

NORTH KOREA

North Korea claimed a successful test of a new hypersonic weapon system following two ballistic missile launches on September 20 — the 14th provocation in the US-Japan-ROK trilateral tracking series — with ****Kim Jong Un**** calling the weapon an 'incurable headache' for adversaries; outside analysts assess it as an upgraded hypersonic glide vehicle. US, Japan, and South Korea consulted trilaterally and reiterated their denuclearization demand at the UN.

RUSSIA

No new Russian military or territorial-dispute activity toward Japan is reported in today's articles; the NYT's in-depth profile of Nemuro's economic dependence on Russia continues to circulate, illustrating the structural constraints on Tokyo's escalation options.

Senkaku / ECS: No new Senkaku intrusion or East China Sea incident is reported in today's articles; the China MOFA Typhon protest represents the current primary Chinese pressure vector.

"China cites risks over Typhon in Japan"

China MOFA spokesperson (unattributed in source) · China cites risks over Typhon in Japan — ECNS

"incurable headache"

Kim Jong Un · North Korea reports new missile test designed to give enemy 'incurable headache' — Reuters

Bottom line: North Korea's claimed hypersonic weapon test — the 14th provocation in the trilateral count — lands as Takaichi is in New York, two days before the Trump-Xi summit; the timing amplifies Tokyo's anxiety that US-China accommodation could reduce pressure on Pyongyang. Beijing's continued Typhon protests maintain dual-front pressure on Japan's defense posture.

• U.S.-JAPAN RELATIONS

ALLIANCE · NIKKEI ASIA

Trump and Takaichi reaffirm alliance on UNGA sidelines, two days before US-China summit

Takaichi entered her September 22 Trump bilateral stressing Japanese investment in the United States; both leaders reaffirmed the alliance with Takaichi describing the discussion as 'timely' as Trump prepares to host Xi Jinping. The summit was the first formal Takaichi-Trump meeting since March.

• INDO-PACIFIC PARTNERS

TRILATERAL · KYODO NEWS

US, Japan and South Korea hold trilateral consultation, address North Korea's 14th missile provocation

US, Japanese, and South Korean officials consulted trilaterally on North Korea's ongoing missile and nuclear activity, characterizing the September 20 launches as the 14th provocation in the tracked series.

KOREA-JAPAN · NHK WORLD

South Korea President Lee seeks resumption of US-North Korea talks on UNGA sidelines

South Korean President Lee used the UNGA sidelines to call for resumption of US-North Korea dialogue, an agenda item that intersects with Japan's trilateral coordination priorities and Tokyo's own denuclearization demands.

SOUTHEAST ASIA · NIKKEI ASIA

Pakistan's new auto policy set to reignite WTO dispute with Japan

Pakistan's revised automotive policy is expected to rekindle a trade dispute with Japan at the WTO, affecting Japanese automakers' market access in South Asia.

• EXPERT ANALYSIS AND EVENTS

OP-EDS & THINK TANK COMMENTARY

CSIS JAPAN CHAIR

Japan as a Maritime Great Power and the China Challenge

Japan's expanding naval capabilities and strategic posture position it as a maritime great power with structural implications for the US-Japan alliance and the China challenge in the Indo-Pacific.

This CSIS Japan Chair analysis examines Japan's evolution as a maritime great power and the challenge China's naval expansion poses to that posture. It assesses the structural shifts in Japanese naval strategy, defense procurement, and the alliance framework required to address Chinese maritime pressure. The piece connects Japan's defense buildup — now at 2% of GDP — to its ambitions for a more decisive maritime role.

SO WHAT Directly relevant to the ongoing 2026 review of Japan's Three Strategic Documents and the US-Japan alliance modernization agenda.

BROOKINGS (SOLÍS)

Japan's exchange rate and creditor status: A longer-term view

Japan's exchange rate dynamics and its status as the world's largest net creditor nation require a longer-term analytical framework that accounts for structural capital flows, not just monetary policy differentials.

This Brookings piece situates Japan's exchange rate — currently at 157.83 per dollar — within its longer-term creditor status, arguing that conventional rate-differential analysis underpredicts structural yen weakness. It examines how Japan's net foreign asset position shapes currency dynamics and capital repatriation pressures. The piece connects BOJ rate normalization to the broader question of whether Japan's creditor status provides a floor for the yen.

SO WHAT Relevant for MOF and BOJ policymakers assessing yen intervention thresholds and the pace of rate normalization.

• UPCOMING

Sep
25

Trump-Xi Washington summit

US President Trump is scheduled to host Chinese leader Xi Jinping in Washington approximately two days after the Takaichi bilateral. Takaichi described her September 22 Trump meeting as 'timely' ahead of this summit; Tokyo is watching for any US-China deal affecting Japan's security equities.

Oct
1

Fall Diet extraordinary session window (estimated)

The fall extraordinary Diet session is expected in the coming weeks; Takaichi has signaled intent to advance tax cut legislation and oil procurement diversification bills. Exact session dates not confirmed in today's articles.

Oct
21

One-year anniversary of Takaichi Cabinet inauguration

The Takaichi Cabinet was inaugurated on October 21, 2025; the one-year mark will draw domestic political assessments of her tenure and approval trajectory.

Nov
1

BOJ Monetary Policy Meeting (estimated)

The Bank of Japan holds approximately eight policy meetings per year; the next meeting following the current 1.25% rate is expected in late October or early November. Exact date not confirmed in today's articles — estimate only.

Nov
3

Culture Day (文化の日)

The 1946 constitution was promulgated on this date.

CSIS Japan Chair

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